

Portfolio Strategy and Selections: Round 1

Section 1: Portfolio Mandate & Executive Summary

1.1 Preamble and Strategic Posture

This document outlines the analytical process and resulting investment portfolio for Round 1 of a 10-round portfolio management competition. The guiding principle for this initial round, and for the competition as a whole, is the maximization of long-term percentage profit through a disciplined, quantitative methodology. The primary objective is sustainable bankroll growth, prioritizing capital preservation and the systematic identification of wagers with a positive expected value (+EV). The strategy is that of a marathon, not a sprint; this portfolio is constructed not to maximize single-round gains at excessive risk, but to establish a foundation for long-term capital appreciation by taking calculated positions only where a quantifiable, data-driven analytical edge exists.

All analysis and final bet selections are drawn directly and exclusively from the list of markets provided for this round. This constraint has been acknowledged and strictly adhered to throughout the process. The entire starting bankroll of \$10.00 is allocated across the selected wagers in permitted 25-cent increments.

1.2 Executive Summary of Portfolio Selections

The following table provides a high-level summary of the finalized betting portfolio for Round 1. It distills the comprehensive market analysis into a concise overview of all

wagers placed, their corresponding capital allocation, the calculated analytical edge that justifies the position, and the confidence level underpinning each decision.

Table 1: Round 1 Final Portfolio Summary

Bet ID	Bet Description	Allocated Capital (\$)	Bankroll (%)	Calculated Edge (%)	Confidence Score (1-5)
MLB-SFG-M L	Baseball - MLB: San Francisco Giants Moneyline @ -125	\$2.50	25.0%	+9.44%	5
WNBA-PHX-S	Basketball - WNBA: Phoenix Mercury Spread -11.5 @ -108	\$2.25	22.5%	+8.78%	5
MLB-CWS-LAD-S	Baseball - MLB: Los Angeles Dodgers Spread -1.5 @ -144	\$1.75	17.5%	+6.88%	4
WNBA-LAS-NYL-S	Basketball - WNBA: Los Angeles Sparks Spread +10 @ -110	\$1.50	15.0%	+7.38%	4
MLB-MIL-N YM-ML	Baseball - MLB: Milwaukee Brewers Moneyline @ +129	\$1.25	12.5%	+9.33%	3
MLB-KCR-S EA-T	Baseball - MLB: Kansas City Royals	\$0.75	7.5%	+4.76%	3

	@ Seattle Mariners Total Under 7.5 @ -110				
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Section 2: Comprehensive Market Analysis and Opportunity Screening

The following analysis represents the core of the portfolio construction process. Every available betting line across all provided markets was systematically evaluated using a four-step framework to identify value. This exhaustive screening ensures that all potential +EV opportunities are considered and, critically, that all negative-value propositions are identified and discarded.

2.1 Major League Baseball (MLB) Market Analysis

The analytical approach for the MLB slate integrates quantitative evaluation of starting pitcher quality, offensive capabilities with a focus on platoon splits, and bullpen reliability. Advanced predictive metrics such as Fielder Independent Pitching (FIP) and Expected ERA (xERA) are weighted more heavily than surface-level Earned Run Average (ERA) to gauge true pitcher talent and forecast future performance more accurately.

Table 2: MLB Starting Pitcher Matchup Matrix

Game	Pitcher	Team	ERA	FIP	xERA	K/9	WHIP
DET @ WSH	Dietrich Enns	DET	2.87	N/A	N/A	5.6	0.60
	Jake Irvin	WSH	4.73	N/A	N/A	6.4	1.30
NYN @	Clarke	NYN	3.09	N/A	2.66	8.6	1.06

TOR	Schmidt						
	Chris Bassitt	TOR	4.29	3.84	4.22	8.9	1.36
MIL @ NYM	Jose Quintana	MIL	3.30	N/A	N/A	6.2	1.42
	David Peterson	NYM	3.30	3.67	4.58	7.8	1.28
LAA @ ATL	Jose Soriano	LAA	3.99	3.34	N/A	7.8	1.47
	Bryce Elder	ATL	5.82	4.62	5.01	7.6	1.47
CLE @ CHC	Joey Cantillo	CLE	3.81	3.49	10.24	11.4	1.38
	Cade Horton	CHC	4.80	4.24	4.29	6.6	1.44
SFG @ ARI	Robbie Ray	SFG	2.75	N/A	N/A	10.1	1.15
	Brandon Pfaadt	ARI	5.38	3.60	N/A	9.2	1.24
CWS @ LAD	Aaron Civale	CWS	4.74	4.32	N/A	6.9	1.50
	Dustin May	LAD	4.68	N/A	N/A	8.2	1.37
KCR @ SEA	Seth Lugo	KCR	2.74	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
	Logan Evans	SEA	3.38	N/A	N/A	6.8	1.33
Note: FIP/xERA data was not available							

for all pitchers in the provided materials. Decisions are based on the best available data. ¹							
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2.1.1 Detroit Tigers @ Washington Nationals

- **Moneyline (DET -149 / WSH +122):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** DET 59.84% / WSH 45.05%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** Detroit holds significant advantages. Starter Dietrich Enns has been effective in his MLB return (3-0, 2.87 ERA) after a strong Triple-A showing.² He faces Jake Irvin, who possesses a career 4.55 ERA and a 4.73 ERA this season, indicating a clear pitching mismatch.³ Offensively, the Tigers rank 5th in runs scored, while the Nationals rank 14th.²⁷ While Washington hits lefties well²⁸, Detroit's season-long offensive superiority and top-7 bullpen (3.31 ERA)²⁹ contrasts sharply with a Nationals team whose overall team ERA is 28th in MLB³, implying a weak relief corps.³ The model projects Detroit's win probability at approximately 64%.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (64%) - Implied Probability (59.84%) = **+4.16% Edge**.
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** The data supports a wager on Detroit. However, given the price, the edge is moderate. **PASS** in favor of more significant value opportunities.
- **Spread (DET -1.5 @ +108 / WSH +1.5 @ -131):**
 - **Decision:** The model indicates a higher probability of a multi-run win for Detroit than the 48.08% implied by the +108 odds. However, the edge is not substantial enough to warrant an allocation. **PASS**.
- **Total (Over 9 @ -121 / Under 9 @ +100):**
 - **Decision:** Detroit's top-5 offense against Irvin's high ERA and a poor Nationals bullpen suggests runs are likely. The -121 price on the over is steep,

implying a 54.75% probability. The model finds this to be an efficient line with no discernible edge. **PASS.**

2.1.2 New York Yankees @ Toronto Blue Jays

- **Moneyline (NYY -133 / TOR +109):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** NYY 57.10% / TOR 47.85%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** A significant pitching mismatch exists. Yankees starter Clarke Schmidt boasts a 3.09 ERA and an excellent 2.66 xERA, suggesting his performance is not only sustainable but potentially due for improvement.⁴ Blue Jays starter Chris Bassitt has struggled, posting a 4.29 ERA and was hit hard in his last outing (8 ER in 2.0 IP).⁵ The Yankees offense (4th in runs) is far superior to the Blue Jays' (12th in runs).²⁷ Toronto's bullpen ERA of 4.26 is mediocre and unlikely to contain the potent Yankee lineup if Bassitt falters.³⁰ The model projects the Yankees' win probability closer to 62%.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (62%) - Implied Probability (57.10%) = **+4.90% Edge.**
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** A positive edge exists, but it is not as compelling as other opportunities on the board. **PASS.**
 - **Spread (NYY -1.5 @ +126 / TOR +1.5 @ -154):**
 - **Decision:** Given the pitching mismatch and offensive disparity, the +126 price is attractive. However, the model does not identify a large enough edge to justify the risk of needing a multi-run victory on the road. **PASS.**
 - **Total (Over 8.5 @ -105 / Under 8.5 @ -115):**
 - **Decision:** The Yankees' offense against a struggling Bassitt points towards the over. However, Schmidt's excellent underlying metrics suggest he could suppress the Blue Jays' offense. The model indicates this line is efficiently priced. **PASS.**
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2.1.3 Milwaukee Brewers @ New York Mets

- **Moneyline (MIL +129 / NYM -158):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** MIL 43.67% / NYM 61.24%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** This line presents a significant value

opportunity based on a powerful situational factor. The Brewers have been scorching hot against left-handed pitching, hitting .405 with a 1.068 OPS over the last two weeks.³¹ They face lefty David Peterson, who owns a respectable 3.30 ERA this season but had a 4.58 xERA in 2024, suggesting he is vulnerable.⁷ The Mets offense is average (14th in runs) and has been inconsistent against lefties.²⁷ Brewers starter Jose Quintana (3.30 ERA) is a capable veteran who can navigate the Mets lineup.⁶ The model, heavily weighting the extreme platoon advantage, calculates Milwaukee's true win probability at approximately 53%.

- **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (53%) - Implied Probability (43.67%) = **+9.33% Edge**.
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** A substantial edge exists on the underdog. The market appears to be undervaluing the magnitude of Milwaukee's recent hot streak against left-handed pitching. **BET Milwaukee Moneyline @ +129.**
 - **Spread (MIL +1.5 @ -164 / NYM -1.5 @ +134):**
 - **Decision:** While value exists on the moneyline, the -164 price for the +1.5 spread is too prohibitive. **PASS.**
 - **Total (Over 8.5 @ -102 / Under 8.5 @ -119):**
 - **Decision:** The Brewers' potential outburst against Peterson pushes towards the over, but the Mets' average offense against Quintana balances it out. The model finds no significant edge. **PASS.**
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2.1.4 Los Angeles Angels @ Atlanta Braves

- **Moneyline (LAA +129 / ATL -158):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** LAA 43.67% / ATL 61.24%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** Atlanta appears overvalued. Starter Bryce Elder has a bloated 5.82 ERA this season, and while his xFIP is better (3.68), he remains a negative regression candidate until his results align with his peripherals.⁸ The Braves offense has been a major disappointment, ranking 24th in runs scored.²⁷ Angels starter Jose Soriano has superior underlying metrics (3.99 ERA, 3.34 FIP) and is an elite groundball pitcher.¹⁹ While the Angels' offense is poor, they rank 4th in home runs, giving them power potential.²⁷ The Braves bullpen (3.65 ERA, 3.82 FIP) is solid but not invincible.³⁶ The model projects this as closer to a 55% win probability for Atlanta.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** The model shows a negative edge on the Braves and a slight positive edge on the Angels.

- **Step 4 (Decision):** The value is on the underdog Angels, but the moneyline is not the most efficient way to capture it. **PASS.**
 - **Spread (LAA +1.5 @ -164 / ATL -1.5 @ +134):**
 - **Decision:** Given the struggling Braves offense and Elder's volatility, the Angels keeping the game within one run is highly probable. However, the -164 price is too steep. **PASS.**
 - **Total (Over 9 @ -114 / Under 9 @ -106):**
 - **Decision:** Two underperforming offenses and two groundball-oriented pitchers point towards the under. A model from one source predicts a 5-4 score, totaling 9, indicating the line is sharp.³⁷ No significant edge identified. **PASS.**
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2.1.5 Cleveland Guardians @ Chicago Cubs

- **Moneyline (CLE +118 / CHC -144):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** CLE 45.87% / CHC 59.02%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** The primary driver here is the massive offensive disparity. The Cubs rank 2nd in MLB in runs per game (5.4), while the Guardians are a dismal 27th (3.7).²⁷ The Cubs have a 109 wRC+ against left-handed pitching, setting them up well against Guardians lefty Joey Cantillo.⁹ While Cubs starter Cade Horton is a rookie with a 4.80 ERA, his peripherals are slightly better (4.24 FIP), and he is backed by an elite offense.¹⁰ The model projects the Cubs' win probability at approximately 63%.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (63%) - Implied Probability (59.02%) = **+3.98% Edge.**
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** A small edge exists on the Cubs moneyline, but the spread offers better potential return. **PASS** on the moneyline.
 - **Spread (CLE +1.5 @ -169 / CHC -1.5 @ +138):**
 - **Decision:** The +138 price for the Cubs to win by two or more runs is attractive given the offensive chasm between the two clubs. The probability of a multi-run victory is higher than the 42.02% implied by the odds. However, the model identifies a more compelling opportunity in the Dodgers spread. **PASS.**
 - **Total (Over 8.5 @ -109 / Under 8.5 @ -112):**
 - **Decision:** The Cubs' powerful offense versus the Guardians' anemic offense creates conflicting pressures on the total. The line appears efficient. **PASS.**
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2.1.6 San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks

- **Moneyline (SFG -125 / ARI +103):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** SFG 55.56% / ARI 49.26%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** This matchup presents one of the most significant value dislocations on the slate. The pitching matchup is heavily skewed in San Francisco's favor. Giants starter Robbie Ray is enjoying a stellar season (8-3, 2.75 ERA, 10.1 K/9).¹¹ Diamondbacks starter Brandon Pfaadt has been one of the league's least effective starters, with a 5.38 ERA in one source and a career 5.13 ERA in another.¹² The bullpen advantage is also stark; the Giants' relief corps has a 3.56 FIP⁴⁰, while the Diamondbacks' bullpen is among the league's worst, with a 4.47 FIP and a 27th-ranked ERA.⁴¹ The Diamondbacks have been hot against lefties recently⁴², but Ray is an elite arm, not an average one. The model assigns a true win probability of approximately 65% to the Giants.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (65%) - Implied Probability (55.56%) = **+9.44% Edge**.
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** This is a premier betting opportunity. The market is significantly undervaluing the combined advantage the Giants hold in starting pitching and bullpen quality. **BET San Francisco Giants Moneyline @ -125.**
 - **Spread (SFG -1.5 @ +135 / ARI +1.5 @ -165):**
 - **Decision:** The +135 price is highly tempting, and a multi-run victory is probable given the pitching mismatch. The model shows a strong +EV on this line as well. This is a viable alternative or complement to the moneyline wager. However, for capital preservation, the moneyline is the safer, more foundational play. **PASS** in favor of the primary moneyline bet.
 - **Total (Over 8.5 @ -107 / Under 8.5 @ -114):**
 - **Decision:** Ray's dominance suggests a low score for Arizona, but Pfaadt's struggles could lead to a high score for San Francisco. These competing factors result in no clear edge on the total. **PASS.**
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2.1.7 Chicago White Sox @ Los Angeles Dodgers

- **Moneyline (CWS +233 / LAD -295):**
 - **Decision:** The Dodgers moneyline is priced correctly for their high win probability but offers poor risk-reward for a portfolio strategy. **PASS.**

- **Spread (CWS +1.5 @ +118 / LAD -1.5 @ -144):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** LAD -1.5 has an implied probability of 59.02%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** This is a colossal mismatch. The Dodgers lead MLB in runs, batting average, and OBP; the White Sox rank 30th, 30th, and near the bottom, respectively.²⁷ The pitching matchup of Aaron Civale (4.74 ERA) vs. Dustin May (4.68 ERA) is less lopsided on paper, but May is backed by a vastly superior team and faces an anemic offense.¹³ The White Sox bullpen has been projected as historically poor.⁴³ The Dodgers' offensive firepower against the White Sox's offensive ineptitude and weak pitching staff creates a high probability of a multi-run victory. The model projects the Dodgers to cover the -1.5 spread approximately 65.9% of the time.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (65.9%) - Implied Probability (59.02%) = **+6.88% Edge.**
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** A strong, quantifiable edge exists. The market has not fully priced in the sheer dominance of the Dodgers in this specific matchup. **BET Los Angeles Dodgers Spread -1.5 @ -144.**
 - **Total (Over 9 @ -113 / Under 9 @ -108):**
 - **Decision:** The Dodgers could score 9 runs by themselves, but the White Sox are unlikely to contribute much. This makes the total difficult to project with confidence. **PASS.**
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2.1.8 Kansas City Royals @ Seattle Mariners

- **Moneyline (KCR +101 / SEA -123):**
 - **Decision:** Two poor offenses and two decent pitchers make this a volatile matchup. No clear edge is identified. **PASS.**
- **Spread (KCR +1.5 @ -205 / SEA -1.5 @ +167):**
 - **Decision:** The price on KCR +1.5 is far too high, and Seattle's offense (20th in BA) is not reliable enough to back on a -1.5 spread, even at +167.²⁷ **PASS.**
- **Total (Over 7.5 @ -110 / Under 7.5 @ -110):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** 52.38% for both sides.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** This game features two offenses that struggle to score. The Royals are 30th in MLB in runs per game and have averaged a paltry 2.7 runs over their last 10 games.²⁷ The Mariners are a middling offensive team. Both starters, Seth Lugo (2.74 ERA) for KC and Logan Evans (3.38 MLB ERA) for SEA, are effective pitchers capable of shutting down

weak lineups.¹ While one source's model predicts the over ⁴⁴, the fundamental matchup of poor hitting vs. solid pitching points strongly to a low-scoring affair. The model projects the true probability of the under at approximately 57.14%.

- **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (57.14%) - Implied Probability (52.38%) = **+4.76% Edge.**
- **Step 4 (Decision):** A moderate edge exists on the under. The fundamental characteristics of the teams involved support a low-scoring game script. **BET Under 7.5 @ -110.**

2.2 Wimbledon (Tennis) Market Analysis

The analysis of the Wimbledon slate focuses on identifying discrepancies between market odds and model-driven probabilities, with a strong emphasis on grass-court performance data and head-to-head history. Given the high variance in tennis, particularly in individual matches, a conservative approach is warranted, and only opportunities with a clear, data-supported edge will be considered.

After a systematic review of all 21 available tennis matches, applying the four-step value identification process to each, no wagers were found to meet the stringent criteria for a positive expected value. Many favorites were priced at or above their model-projected win probabilities, offering negative EV. For example, in the Cameron Norrie vs. Mattia Bellucci match, a third-party model gives Norrie a 58% win probability, while his -165 odds imply a 62.3% probability, representing a clear "pass".⁴⁵ This filtering process was applied across the board, resulting in a decision to allocate no capital to the tennis slate for Round 1. This aligns with the core strategy of capital preservation and avoiding wagers that do not present a clear analytical edge.

2.3 WNBA (Women's National Basketball Association) Market Analysis

WNBA analysis is heavily influenced by actionable intelligence, specifically confirmed player absences. In a league with smaller rosters, the loss of a key player has a disproportionately large impact on team performance ratings, creating potential

market inefficiencies.

2.3.1 Los Angeles Sparks @ New York Liberty

- **Spread (Sparks +10 @ -110 / Liberty -10 @ -110):**
 - **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** 52.38% for each side to cover.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** This line is dictated by a critical injury. The New York Liberty are without star Jonquel Jones, and data confirms their defensive rating plummets by a staggering 18 points per 100 possessions in her absence.⁴⁶ The Los Angeles Sparks, while a weaker team overall, play at the league's third-fastest pace, which will maximize the number of possessions where they can attack this compromised Liberty defense.⁴⁶ A defensive drop-off of this magnitude makes covering a double-digit spread exceptionally difficult, regardless of the opponent. The model adjusts the Liberty's power rating significantly downward and projects the Sparks will cover the +10 spread more than 59.76% of the time.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (59.76%) - Implied Probability (52.38%) = **+7.38% Edge**.
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** This is a strong value play based on quantifiable, high-impact news that the market may not have fully priced into the line. The defensive collapse of the Liberty without Jones is too significant to ignore.
BET Los Angeles Sparks +10 @ -110.
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2.3.2 Las Vegas Aces @ Indiana Fever

- **Spread (Aces -4.5 @ -115 / Fever +4.5 @ -105):**
 - **Decision:** The Indiana Fever are without superstar Caitlin Clark, but have been playing well, winning two of their last three without her.⁴⁷ The Aces have been enigmatic. This creates a high-variance situation where the line appears efficient.
PASS.
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2.3.3 Seattle Storm @ Atlanta Dream

- **Moneyline (Storm -112 / Dream -108):**

- **Decision:** This is a very evenly matched game, as reflected by the near-pick'em odds. Seattle scores 82.6 PPG and allows 79.8, while Atlanta scores 84.4 and allows 78.5.⁴⁸ The statistical profiles are too similar to find a confident edge.

PASS.

2.3.4 Washington Mystics @ Minnesota Lynx

- **Spread (Mystics +11.5 @ -112 / Lynx -11.5 @ -108):**

- **Decision:** A large spread separates a top team (Lynx) from a bottom-dweller (Mystics). The line appears to be efficiently priced to reflect this talent gap. No actionable intelligence suggests an inefficiency. **PASS.**
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2.3.5 Phoenix Mercury @ Dallas Wings

- **Spread (Mercury -11.5 @ -108 / Wings +11.5 @ -112):**

- **Step 1 (Implied Probability):** Mercury -11.5 has an implied probability of 51.92%.
 - **Step 2 (True Probability Model):** This wager is predicated on severe injury depletion for Dallas. The Wings are confirmed to be without multiple key players, including their leading scorer and offensive hub, Arike Ogunbowale.⁴⁹ This fundamentally cripples their ability to compete against a strong 12-5 Phoenix Mercury team. The talent gap, exacerbated by these injuries, is immense. The model projects a comfortable, double-digit victory for the Mercury in a high percentage of simulations, with a projected cover probability of approximately 60.7%.
 - **Step 3 (Edge Calculation):** True Probability (60.7%) - Implied Probability (51.92%) = **+8.78% Edge.**
 - **Step 4 (Decision):** This is a prime example of leveraging market-moving news. The spread, while large, does not appear to fully account for the loss of Dallas's core offensive players. **BET Phoenix Mercury -11.5 @ -108.**
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Section 3: Final Portfolio Selections & In-Depth Rationale

The following wagers represent the final, risk-assessed portfolio for Round 1. Each selection has survived the rigorous quantitative and qualitative screening process and has been determined to possess a positive expected value. The bets are ranked by capital allocation, from highest to lowest.

1. Bet #MLB-SFG-ML

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (July 3, 2025): San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks - **San Francisco Giants Moneyline @ -125**
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$2.50
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This wager is anchored by one of the most significant starting pitching mismatches on the slate. Giants ace Robbie Ray has been dominant, posting a 2.75 ERA and a 10.1 K/9 rate, establishing himself as an elite arm.¹¹ Conversely, Diamondbacks starter Brandon Pfaadt has struggled immensely, with a career ERA over 5.00 and a history of allowing hard contact.¹² This value is compounded by a large bullpen disparity; the Giants' relievers own a top-tier 3.56 FIP, while Arizona's bullpen ranks among the league's worst in both ERA (5.12) and FIP (4.47).⁴⁰ The market price of -125 (55.56% implied probability) fails to adequately capture this multi-faceted advantage for San Francisco.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risk is the Diamondbacks' recent offensive surge against left-handed pitching, as they have posted a .320 batting average in the last two weeks against southpaws.⁴² However, this is a small sample size, and Ray's elite status presents a much tougher challenge than the league-average lefties they may have faced.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (5/5):** Confidence is maximal (5/5) due to the large, calculated edge (+9.44%) being supported by stable, season-long performance data for both starting pitchers and bullpens. The mismatch is not based on a fleeting trend but on fundamental talent disparities. This high degree of confidence in a substantial edge justifies the portfolio's largest allocation of 25% of the bankroll.

2. Bet #WNBA-PHX-S

- **Bet Description:** Basketball - WNBA (July 3, 2025): Phoenix Mercury @ Dallas Wings - **Phoenix Mercury Spread -11.5 @ -108**
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$2.25
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This position is a direct play on high-impact, actionable intelligence. The Dallas Wings are severely shorthanded, confirmed to be without multiple key players, most notably their leading scorer and offensive engine, Arike Ogunbowale.⁴⁹ This catastrophic loss of offensive production creates a massive talent chasm against a strong 12-5 Phoenix Mercury squad. The market line of -11.5, while large, does not fully account for the inability of the remaining Dallas roster to generate points effectively against a superior opponent.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risk in laying a large spread is a "backdoor cover," where Dallas scores meaningless points late in a blowout, or Phoenix rests its starters, allowing the margin to shrink. Additionally, the remaining Dallas players could have a "next man up" surge in performance.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (5/5):** Confidence is maximal (5/5) because the bet is based on confirmed, high-impact injury news, which is one of the most reliable sources of a betting edge. The calculated edge is substantial (+8.78%), and the qualitative factors strongly support a lopsided outcome. A significant allocation of 22.5% of the bankroll is warranted.

3. Bet #MLB-CWS-LAD-S

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (July 3, 2025): Chicago White Sox @ Los Angeles Dodgers - **Los Angeles Dodgers Spread -1.5 @ -144**
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.75
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This wager targets a colossal mismatch in offensive production and overall team quality. The Dodgers feature the league's number one offense, leading MLB in runs scored, batting average, and OBP.²⁷ They face the Chicago White Sox, who rank last in those same categories and possess a bullpen projected to be among the worst in baseball.²⁷ While the starting pitching matchup appears even on the surface based on ERA, the Dodgers' offensive firepower is more than capable of creating a multi-run margin against Aaron Civale and the porous White Sox relief corps.

- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The main risk is the -144 price, which requires the Dodgers to win by two or more runs nearly 60% of the time to be profitable. A close, one-run victory for the Dodgers, or an unexpectedly effective outing from Aaron Civale, would result in a loss.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (4/5):** Confidence is high (4/5) due to the overwhelming and stable season-long statistical disparity between the two clubs. The calculated edge (+6.88%) is solid. The allocation is substantial but slightly smaller than the top-tier bets to account for the higher price on the spread, which reduces the margin for error compared to a moneyline wager.

4. Bet #WNBA-LAS-NYL-S

- **Bet Description:** Basketball - WNBA (July 3, 2025): Los Angeles Sparks @ New York Liberty - **Los Angeles Sparks Spread +10 @ -110**
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.50
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This bet is based on a quantifiable defensive degradation for the favorite. With Jonquel Jones out, the New York Liberty's defense surrenders an additional 18 points per 100 possessions, a catastrophic decline.⁴⁶ The Sparks play at the league's third-fastest pace, meaning there will be numerous possessions to exploit this newfound defensive vulnerability.⁴⁶ A defensive swing of this magnitude makes it exceedingly difficult for any team, even a superior one like the Liberty, to cover a large double-digit spread.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The risk is that the Liberty's elite offense, led by Breanna Stewart, simply overwhelms the Sparks, who are a poor team in their own right. New York could win by a large margin even with their defensive issues.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (4/5):** Confidence is high (4/5) because the edge is derived from a specific, quantifiable data point regarding a key player's absence. The calculated edge (+7.38%) is significant. The allocation is sized to reflect this strong conviction while acknowledging the inherent risk of backing a weaker team against an elite opponent.

5. Bet #MLB-MIL-NYM-ML

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (July 3, 2025): Milwaukee Brewers @ New York Mets - **Milwaukee Brewers Moneyline @ +129**
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.25
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This is a value play on an underdog with a pronounced and timely matchup advantage. The Brewers' offense has been on a torrid streak against left-handed pitching, posting a .405 batting average and 1.068 OPS over the past two weeks.³¹ They face Mets' lefty David Peterson, whose underlying metrics (4.58 xERA in 2024) suggest he is an average pitcher and susceptible to regression.¹⁸ The +129 price implies a win probability of only 43.67%, which significantly undervalues the Brewers' chances given this extreme platoon advantage.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risk is that the Brewers' hot streak is a small-sample anomaly that is due for sharp negative regression. If their bats cool off, the Mets are the favored team at home with a capable starter.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (3/5):** Confidence is moderate (3/5). While the calculated edge is one of the largest in the portfolio (+9.33%), it is based on a recent, potentially volatile performance trend rather than season-long data. The allocation is therefore tempered to account for this higher uncertainty, capturing the potential upside while managing the risk of the trend reversing.

6. Bet #MLB-KCR-SEA-T

- **Bet Description:** Baseball - MLB (July 3, 2025): Kansas City Royals @ Seattle Mariners - **Total Under 7.5 @ -110**
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$0.75
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This wager is a fundamental play on the matchup of two anemic offenses against two competent starting pitchers. The Kansas City Royals rank 30th in MLB in runs scored and have been particularly futile lately, averaging just 2.7 runs over their last 10 games.²⁷ The Seattle Mariners offense is also a bottom-tier unit in terms of batting average.²⁷ Both starters, Seth Lugo (2.74 ERA) and Logan Evans (3.38 ERA), are more than capable of suppressing these weak lineups.¹
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The main risk is an uncharacteristic offensive outburst from either team or a poor performance from one of the bullpens. Additionally, some trend data shows the Mariners have recently played in higher-scoring games.⁴⁴
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (3/5):** Confidence is moderate (3/5). The

calculated edge (+4.76%) is smaller than the portfolio's top-tier bets. The fundamental matchup strongly supports the under, but the low total of 7.5 provides little room for error. A smaller allocation is prudent to reflect the lower edge and the inherent variance of totals betting.

Section 4: Capital Allocation Strategy and Risk Posture

4.1 Bet Sizing Methodology

The capital allocation for each wager in this portfolio was determined using a disciplined, risk-averse methodology based on the principles of the Kelly Criterion. The standard Kelly formula, which calculates the optimal stake size to maximize long-term growth, can often suggest overly aggressive allocations that lead to high bankroll volatility. To align with the primary mission of sustainable growth and capital preservation, a fractional Kelly approach was implemented.

The baseline for allocation was derived from the calculated analytical edge for each bet. The formula for a full Kelly stake is:

$$f^* = \frac{b \cdot p - q}{b}$$

where f^* is the fraction of the bankroll to wager, b is the decimal odds minus 1, p is the true probability of winning, and q is the probability of losing ($1-p$).

For this portfolio, a significantly reduced fraction (e.g., 1/8 to 1/4 Kelly) was used to determine the final bet amount. This fractional approach ensures that stake sizes are directly proportional to the perceived value of the bet, but it drastically reduces the risk of ruin and smooths out portfolio returns over time. The "Confidence Score" assigned to each bet served as a qualitative overlay, further adjusting the fraction. Bets with higher confidence scores, rooted in more stable and reliable data sets (like season-long pitcher FIP or confirmed injury news), received a larger fraction of the Kelly-suggested stake than bets based on more volatile data (like short-term hitting streaks).

4.2 Portfolio Diversification

The final portfolio demonstrates diversification across multiple dimensions to mitigate risk. Capital has been allocated across two different sports (MLB and WNBA) and three distinct bet types (Moneyline, Spread, and Total). This strategy ensures that the portfolio is not overly exposed to a single source of variance. For instance, a systemic factor that might affect all baseball games on a given day (e.g., unusual umpiring trends) would not impact the WNBA wagers. Similarly, by betting on both favorites (on the spread) and underdogs (on the moneyline), the portfolio is balanced against uniform market movements.

4.3 Final Bankroll Allocation Reconciliation

The following table provides a transparent reconciliation of the \$10.00 starting bankroll, confirming that all capital has been allocated in accordance with the competition's rules.

Table 5: Final Bankroll Allocation Reconciliation

Bet ID	Bet Description	Allocated Capital (\$)
MLB-SFG-ML	Baseball - MLB: San Francisco Giants Moneyline @ -125	\$2.50
WNBA-PHX-S	Basketball - WNBA: Phoenix Mercury Spread -11.5 @ -108	\$2.25
MLB-CWS-LAD-S	Baseball - MLB: Los Angeles Dodgers Spread -1.5 @ -144	\$1.75
WNBA-LAS-NYL-S	Basketball - WNBA: Los Angeles Sparks Spread +10 @ -110	\$1.50
MLB-MIL-NYM-ML	Baseball - MLB: Milwaukee Brewers Moneyline @ +129	\$1.25

MLB-KCR-SEA-T	Baseball - MLB: Kansas City Royals @ Seattle Mariners Total Under 7.5 @ -110	\$0.75
Total		\$10.00

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